

Family Planning

You give information, counsel, and refer. Help women and men make their own informed choice, and listen to what stops them.

For health workers

Key messages

- Explain family planning as a voluntary, informed choice about when to have children, how many, and the time between them.
- Know the methods and where they are available: condom, implant, injection, IUD, pills, ovulation method, tubal ligation, vasectomy, and the emergency pill.
- Say clearly that condoms are the only method that protects against both pregnancy and STIs including HIV.
- Listen for barriers: fear of side effects, a partner who does not agree, myths, distance. Use the steps of behaviour

change communication to find solutions.

- Take special care to be respectful and private with young people, women who had a near-miss or emergency in a past birth, and women with disabilities or illness.
- Refer to the health facility for the method chosen.
- All family planning is free at government health facilities. Report any health worker selling contraceptives.

Refer if

- A woman has a problem or side effect with a method
- Unprotected sex and she wants the emergency pill within 5 days
- Signs of a sexually transmitted infection

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.

2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.